

Fianchettoes need diagonal awareness

Opening Decisions

THE IDEA

A bishop developed to g2, b2, g7, or b7 can influence a long diagonal. Its power depends on blockers and central pawn breaks. Moving the nearby pawn also changes the king's shelter and creates squares that may need defense.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A bishop on g2 behind a white pawn on e4 may be temporarily restricted along g2-f3-e4. Advancing or exchanging the central pawn can release it. Trading the fianchettoed bishop may leave weak squares near a castled king.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What should you inspect before exchanging your fianchettoed bishop?

ANSWER AND REASONING

Whether other pieces can defend its color complex and whether the opponent can use the long diagonal or nearby holes. The exchange may still be good if it removes a stronger attacker.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Judge the bishop together with its diagonal and king shelter.